I am choosing to explore mechanisms like clasps, hinges, and catches. This interests me because it allows the creation of an enhanced decoration. It can look very nice and intricate, however it can also move and in many cases serves a function like holding something. I also have a mechanical project that I would like to finish, but I don't know how to make a good catch to finish it. I want to make a hand or claw that can grip into a fist. This could be in order to conceal something in the hand. I may also make something else like a hinged box if I have time. I probably won't decorate this hand too much, and I may only make it an outline of the actual hand like this ring to the right. I would like to use a lever to open and shut the hand. This way it could stay in an open or stay in a shut state when I wanted it too. I would use wires and springs in order to make this lever mechanism work, as I want it to spring down to cover the object if possible and slowly open up. It would be similar to mechanisms created by Dukno Yoon. If I have extra time I would like to look into mokume-gane, because I think it looks really interesting. I love the wood like texture that appears with this technique.

For this project I will need copper wire, specifically a small gauge like >14. I may also need some much smaller wire, but I think it will be okay. I would also like to have a wire that can go around another wire, like a pipe. I will also need some copper plates, they don't have to be huge, around a 3x3 inch square should be okay. I will need a spring to hold the hand compressed. I will need to use one of the flex shafts and also many of the wire bending tools. Along with that I will probably need a saw, and the hammering equipment. I will definitely need the torch to solder.

Timeline:
Week 1, Make 1 functional finger. Week 2, Make the palm and main hand part and 1 more functional finger. Week 3, Create a lever to open and close the hand and connect it to the fingers. Week 4, Make 3 more fingers. Week 5, Attach the last fingers, final touches, make it look nice, fix any problems.